

Professional Profile

I am a Junior Java backend developer who is detail-oriented, structured, and strongly committed to building secure, reliable systems that deliver real value. I take complete ownership and responsibility for my work, staying with problems until they are properly solved, and always keeping long-term maintainability and quality in mind.

I stand out through my calm and professional approach under pressure, combined with a genuine passion for continuous learning and improvement. I am collaborative in team settings, honest in my communication, disciplined in how I organise and document my work, and naturally security-conscious in everything I build. My AZ-500 and SC-200 Microsoft Azure certifications further support this approach.

I am a strong fit for a team that values dependable developers who take pride in their craft. I am a dedicated contributor who pays close attention to detail, works effectively with others, and consistently delivers thoughtful, well-documented solutions that support business goals.

Technical Skills

Backend Development:

Java, Spring Boot, Spring Data JPA, JDBC, C#, REST APIs, microservices, ASP.NET Core, Django

Testing & Quality:

JUnit, Mockito, Postman, unit and integration testing, regression testing

Database:

MySQL, SQLite, SSMS, PostgreSQL, query optimisation, ER diagramming

Cloud & Security:

Microsoft Azure (AZ-500, SC-200 certified), IAM, secure REST API design, threat awareness, vulnerability mitigation, security best practices

DevOps & Tools:

Git/GitHub, Maven, CI/CD fundamentals, SDLC, Agile/Scrum

Frontend (basic exposure):

React.js, React Native

Professional Experience

Work Integrated Learning Intern (Backend Developer)

KAYISE IT | Oct 2025 – Dec 2025

- Took full ownership of the backend development for a mobile-first accounting application built for small and medium enterprises, delivering a secure and reliable solution that balanced business needs with strong data protection.
- Designed and implemented a robust MySQL database structure with role-based access control and encrypted storage, significantly reducing the risk of unauthorised access to sensitive financial information.
- Integrated AI-powered bank statement categorisation and OCR receipt extraction, which improved the speed, accuracy, and overall efficiency of financial data processing for end users.
- Developed secure REST APIs following security-by-design principles, ensuring confidentiality and integrity of all transactions and communications.
- Led backend testing and quality assurance using Postman, while producing comprehensive technical documentation that supported smooth team handover and long-term maintainability.
- Delivered a stable, production-ready prototype that combined practical functionality with compliance standards, adding real value to SME users.

Work Integrated Learning Intern (Software Engineering)

KAYISE IT, Pretoria | Jul 2024

- Played a key role in enhancing a Learning Management System by identifying critical performance bottlenecks and optimising MySQL queries, resulting in approximately 30% faster system load times.
 - Improved data validation rules and backend logic to prevent inconsistent data states, leading to a more reliable and scalable platform for admins, lecturers, and students.
 - Built and maintained core features for user registration, content management, and traceability in a three-person team, completing the work over 10 days using Django, MongoDB, React.js and GitHub.
 - Focused on writing clean, well-structured code and detailed documentation, which made future development and maintenance significantly easier for the team.
 - Conducted thorough regression testing to ensure system stability after changes, contributing to an improved user experience across the entire platform.
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Key Projects

Employee Onboarding System (Microservices)

Java, Spring Boot, MySQL, JUnit

- Took full ownership of building a multi-service microservices architecture that mirrors real enterprise environments, with dedicated services for Personal Information, Role Assignment, and Access Provisioning.
 - Designed and developed secure RESTful APIs using Spring Boot, enabling reliable and protected JSON communication between services while maintaining clear separation of concerns.
 - Created well-structured MySQL database schemas and ER diagrams, ensuring efficient data management and scalability through MySQL Workbench.
 - Conducted thorough testing of all endpoints (GET, POST, PUT, DELETE) using Postman and JUnit, delivering a reliable system with strong data integrity and fewer production issues.
 - Applied key microservices principles including service isolation, secure access control, and organised data flow, resulting in a maintainable foundation that supports long-term business growth.
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Library Management System

Java, JUnit, MySQL

- Developed a console-based system to manage book lending, member records, and overdue tracking.
 - Designed the MySQL database schema and wrote over 50 JUnit tests to enforce business rules and data integrity.
 - Added input validation to handle edge cases and ensure consistent system behaviour.
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Task Manager Application

Java, MySQL

- Built a GUI-based task management application with filtering, categorisation, and persistent storage.
 - Applied modular and object-oriented design to improve maintainability and readability.
 - Used collections to manage tasks efficiently, supporting better organisation and productivity.
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Book Manager API

C#, .NET

- Developed a RESTful API with full CRUD operations for managing book records.
 - Structured backend logic with clear separation of concerns for high maintainability.
 - Tested endpoints thoroughly and managed development using Git with full documentation.
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Education

CTU Training Solutions, Pretoria, South Africa

National Certificate: IT Database Development (NQF Level 6, diploma-equivalent) | 2025

Modules: Advanced Design Patterns, Data Solution Development, IT Project Management, Cybersecurity Professional Practice, Work Integrated Learning

National Certificate: IT Systems Development (NQF Level 5) | 2024

Modules: Advanced Java, Programming with C#, DevOps Engineering, Beginner Java, Work Integrated Learning

National Certificate: IT Systems Development (NQF Level 4) | 2023

Modules: Programming with Python, Cloud Fundamentals, Core Web Development, Network Architecture, Work Integrated Learning

The Glen High School | Matric | 2021

Relevant subjects: Computer Applications Technology, Business Studies

Certifications

- AZ-500: Microsoft Certified: Azure Security Engineer Associate (2025)
 - SC-200: Microsoft Certified: Security Operations Analyst Associate (2025)
 - AI-900: Microsoft Certified: AI Fundamentals (2024)
 - DP-900: Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Fundamentals (2023)
 - Certiport: IT Specialist - HTML, CSS, JavaScript (2023)
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References

- Lusukama Selemani, Software Development Facilitator, CTU Training Solutions | lusukama.selemani@ctutrainig.co.za | Phone: 087 702 2625 (Office)
- Thando Hlophe, Founder and Director, KAYISE IT | thando@kayiseit.com | Phone: 012 470 9500 (Office)
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